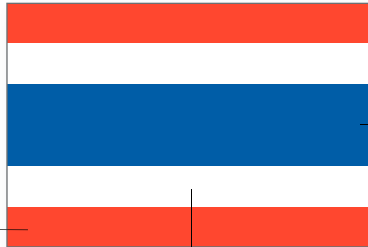


Thailand

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** September 28, 1917 **Usage:** National and Civil

The blue and white stripes were added during World War I

Red symbolizes life-blood



Blue represents the monarchy

White stands for the purity of the Buddhist faith

Asia



Formerly known as the Kingdom of Siam, **Thailand** is the only Southeast Asian nation never to have been colonized.

Thailand is also known as the “Land of the White Elephant,” and this emblem appeared on its plain red flag in the 19th century. During World War I, horizontal white stripes were added above and below the elephant.

In 1917 the elephant was abandoned, and a blue stripe was

added to the middle of the flag in order to express solidarity with the Allies, whose flags were mostly red, white and blue. This flag is known as the *Trairanga* (tricolor).

The Royal Arms of Thailand was introduced in 1910. The arms feature the *garuda*, a bird-man in Hindu mythology.

ARMS OF THAILAND

The garuda of Hindu mythology is the enemy of all things poisonous



The red garuda is placed on a field of royal yellow for the Royal Standard